

Global launch activity, 2020 to 2026

1,500 completed launches from Launch Library 2, pulled 19 September 2026

1,500	95.6%	341	42%
completed launches	launched successfully	launches in 2025	flown by SpaceX

Summary

Launch volume more than doubled between 2021 and 2025, from about 160 launches a year to 341. SpaceX flew 42% of the 1,500 launches in this dataset. Falcon 9 alone flew 600 of them and failed once.

Rockets with longer records fail less often. Twelve rockets flew at least 20 times in the window, made 998 launches between them, and failed 8 times. The other 502 launches, from rockets with shorter records, produced 58 of the 66 failures in the data.

These numbers cover the 1,500 most recent launches in the database, from part of 2020 to 19 September 2026. They are not all-time figures, and the first and last years are partial.

Launch volume

Launches rose every year from 2021 to 2025, from about 160 to 341. The largest single jump came in 2025, which added about 70 launches over 2024.

2026 stands at about 230 launches as of 19 September. Extended over a full year at that rate, the total would land near 320, a little below 2025. The 2020 bar is short because the 1,500-launch window starts partway through that year, so it says nothing about how many launches 2020 had.

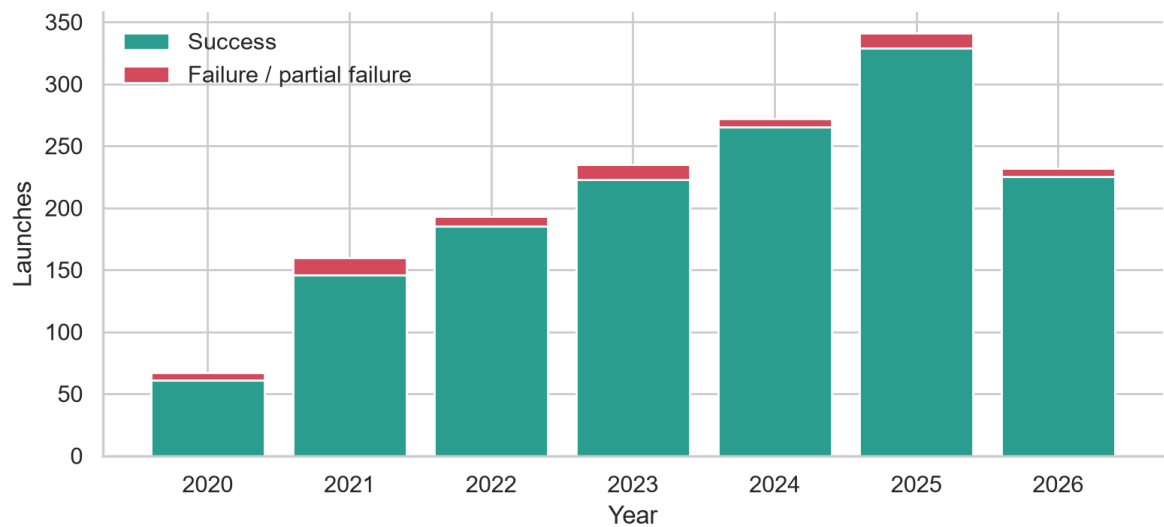


Figure 1. Completed launches per year, split by outcome. 2020 starts partway through the year; 2026 runs to 19 September.

Reliability

1,434 of the 1,500 launches succeeded, a rate of 95.6%. The other 66 ended in a failure or a partial failure. Failures were more common early in the window: about 9% of launches in 2020 and 2021 failed, against about 3% from 2024 to 2026.

Falcon 9 flew 600 times, 40% of all launches in the data, and 599 of those launches succeeded. Seven rockets in the table below have flown 20 or more times with no failures: Long March 2C, 2D, 4B, 4C and 6A, and the Soyuz 2.1a and 2.1b/Fregat-M.

Kuaizhou 1A is the weak point, with three failures in 22 launches for a success rate of 86.4%. Electron failed twice in 83 launches.

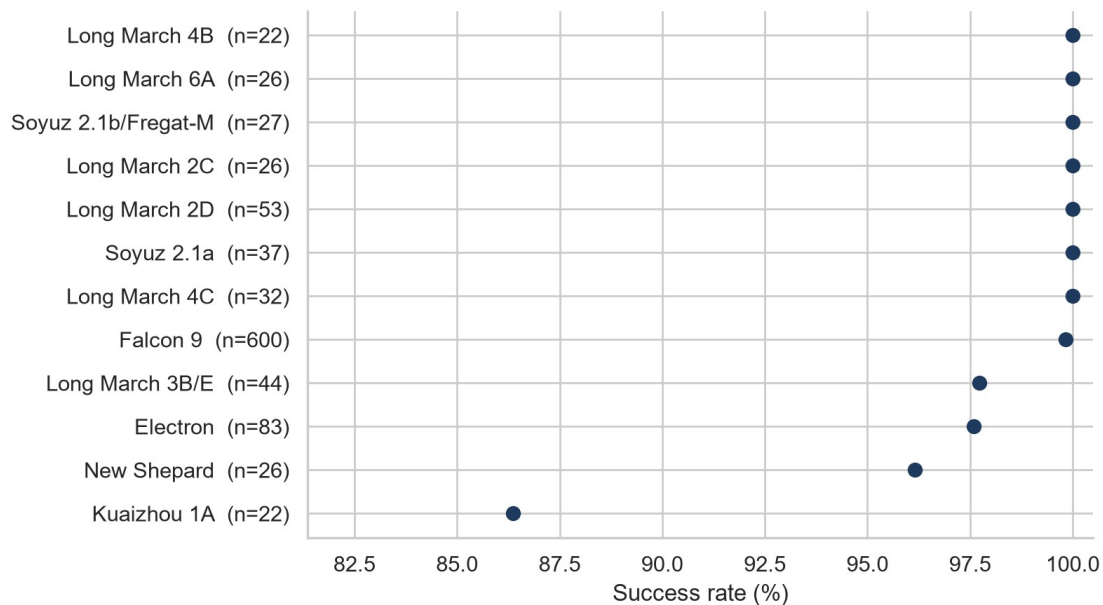


Figure 2. Success rate of each rocket with at least 20 launches. The axis runs from about 81% to 100%, so small gaps look larger than they are.

Table 1. Every rocket with 20 or more launches in the window, sorted by launches.

Rocket	Launches	Failures	Success rate
Falcon 9	600	1	99.8%
Electron	83	2	97.6%
Long March 2D	53	0	100.0%
Long March 3B/E	44	1	97.7%
Soyuz 2.1a	37	0	100.0%
Long March 4C	32	0	100.0%
Soyuz 2.1b/Fregat-M	27	0	100.0%
Long March 2C	26	0	100.0%
Long March 6A	26	0	100.0%
New Shepard	26	1	96.2%
Kuaizhou 1A	22	3	86.4%

Rocket	Launches	Failures	Success rate
Long March 4B	22	0	100.0%

The table leaves out rockets with fewer than 20 launches, and including them changes the picture. The twelve rockets above flew 998 of the 1,500 launches and failed 8 times, a success rate of 99.2%. The other 502 launches produced 58 failures, a success rate of 88.4%.

The comparison is biased. A rocket that fails early rarely reaches 20 launches, so the table selects for vehicles that already work. The second group also mixes debut rockets with older ones that fly a few times a year, and this analysis cannot separate them.

Providers and orbits

SpaceX led with about 630 launches, 42% of the total. A Chinese state-owned aerospace group came second with about 330. Together they flew about 64% of the launches in the window.

Rocket Lab is third on the chart with 83 launches, but Russian launches appear under two names in the source data: the Russian Federal Space Agency (about 54) and the Russian Space Forces (about 46). Merged, they total about 100 and would edge past Rocket Lab. Arianespace and United Launch Alliance follow with about 40 and 35.

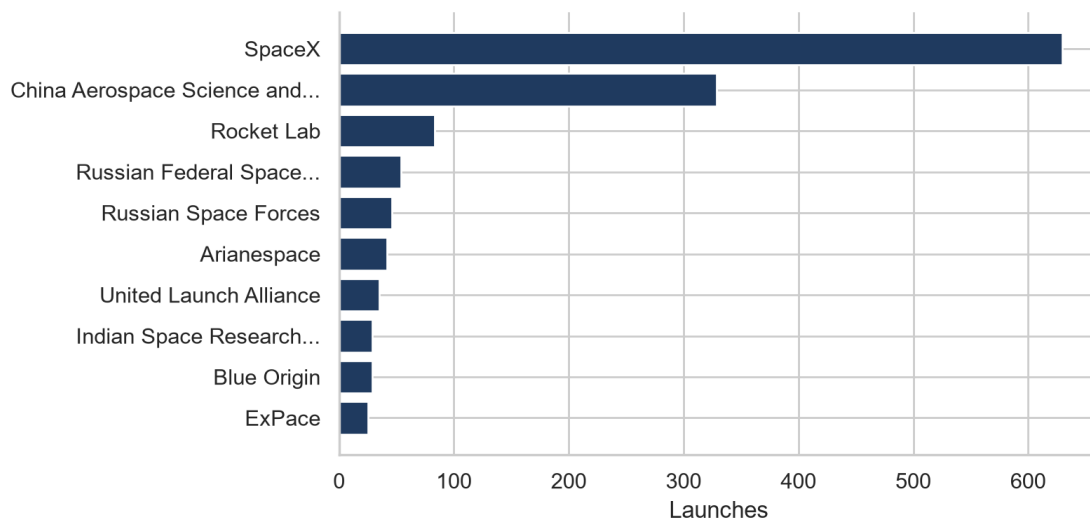


Figure 3. The ten providers with the most launches. Long names are cut off in the chart; the second bar is the Chinese group described above.

Low Earth orbit (LEO) is the most common destination, at about 785 launches, more than half the total. Sun-synchronous orbit (SSO) comes next with about 300, one launch in five, followed by geostationary transfer orbit (GTO) with about 125. About 75 launches were suborbital.

The data lists destinations, not payloads, so it cannot say what those launches carried.

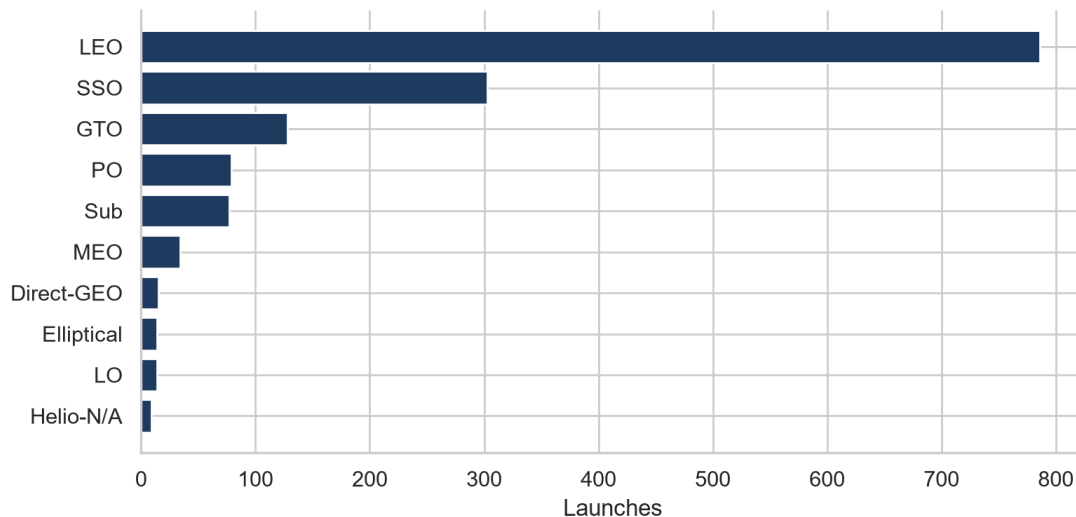


Figure 4. The ten most common target orbits. MEO is medium Earth orbit and Sub is suborbital. Launches with an unknown orbit are excluded.

About the data

I pulled the data from Launch Library 2, a community-maintained database run by The Space Devs (thespacedevs.com). It lists 7,623 past launches. The free API tier limits how many requests a user can make, and results arrive newest first, so this report covers the 1,500 most recent launches instead of the full archive.

A launch counts as a success only when its status is Launch Successful, and partial failures count as failures. The analysis excludes launches with no recorded outcome, such as scheduled ones. The database also includes suborbital flights, for example Blue Origin's New Shepard, so the totals cover more than orbital launches. Rocket, provider and orbit names appear as the source spells them.

Two edges of the window are partial. The 2020 figures cover only the months the window reaches, and the 2026 figures stop at 19 September. Every rocket and provider figure describes this window and not the full history of that vehicle or company.